Competitor scan

Monday, Oct 12, 2026 · US pages · Unpopular Truths + The 50 State Wire

a. Summary: 5 takeaways

- **Unpopular Truths: 0 Reels live on Oct 11**, and none by midday Oct 12. Newest Reel: Oct 10. The Oct 11 draft had 10 videos ready for posting by hand.
- **News page: storms win again.** Hurricane deaths: 1,140 plays. Tornadoes (today): 92. The other 12 Reels: 0 to 19 each.
- **New tracked page: The Dodo**, 51.77M likes (Social Blade, Oct 8). Replaces Tank's Good News.
- **Meta checks originality.** It fingerprints videos and asks viewers to rate interest 1 to 5 (Social Media Examiner, Apr 2026).
- **New niches:** wildlife 6.0, money lessons 5.8, DIY 5.2. None enters the top 5.

Limit: Facebook pages still refuse this job, so competitor posts per day, length and music stay unknown. Pasting page and Reel links into the task would let them be opened.

b. Top pages: motivation quotes

Power of Positivity

- Followers: 35.65M likes (Social Blade, Oct 1)
- Themes: positivity, self-help
- Formats, posts/day: unknown
- Signals: own site, books. FB pay: unknown (low)

Jay Shetty

- Followers: 20M+ (2019; now unknown)
- Themes: narrated life advice video
- Formats, posts/day: unknown
- Signals: $1M video ads in 2019 (low for today)

Tony Robbins

- Followers: 7.1M (Feedspot, Aug)
- Themes: personal growth
- Formats, posts/day: unknown
- Signals: events, books (low)

Tiny Buddha

- Followers: 5.5M (Feedspot, Aug)
- Themes: wisdom, life lessons
- Formats, posts/day: unknown
- Signals: site, books (low)

SUCCESS

- Followers: 3.8M (Feedspot, Aug)
- Themes: achievement, careers
- Formats, posts/day: unknown
- Signals: magazine ads (low)

Addicted 2 Success

- Followers: 1.9M (Feedspot, Aug)
- Themes: success quotes
- Formats, posts/day: unknown
- Signals: own site (low)

Mel Robbins

- Followers: FB unknown; 25.3M other platforms
- Themes: advice to camera, US
- Formats, posts/day: unknown
- Signals: books, podcast (low)

Great Big Minds

- Followers: 1.2M (Feedspot, Aug)
- Themes: unknown
- Formats, posts/day: unknown
- weak: 4 days unmeasured

Pick the Brain

- Followers: 790.2K (Feedspot, Aug)
- Themes: self-improvement
- Formats, posts/day: unknown
- weak: 4 days unmeasured

A Beautiful Mess Inside

- Followers: 696K+ (2025 list)
- Themes: unknown
- Formats, posts/day: unknown
- weak: 4 days unmeasured

Lessons Learned In Life

- Followers: unknown
- Themes: life-lesson quotes
- Formats, posts/day: unknown
- weak; closest to our format

b. Top pages: news and good news

The Dodo (NEW)

- Followers: 51.77M likes, 5.83M talking about (Social Blade, Oct 8)
- Themes: animal and feel-good stories
- Posts/day: unknown
- FB pay: unknown (low)

CNN

- Followers: 43.82M likes (Social Blade, Oct 11)
- Themes: breaking news
- Posts/day: unknown
- Meta AI licensing deal (medium); FB pay unknown (low)

Fox News

- Followers: 37.30M likes, 6.11M talking about (Social Blade, Oct 11)
- Themes: politics, big events; links about half of posts (2025)
- Posts/day: unknown
- Meta AI licensing deal (medium)

Upworthy

- Followers: 10.1M (Feedspot, Jul)
- Themes: kindness, human interest
- Posts/day: unknown
- own site (low)

TODAY

- Followers: 8.6M (Feedspot, Jul)
- Themes: feel-good, family
- Posts/day: unknown
- broadcaster (low)

CBS News

- Followers: unknown
- Themes: politics; animal stories get about half of engagement; clips under 30 s did best (NewsWhip 2025)
- Posts/day: unknown
- in-video ads likely, not confirmed (low)

ABC News

- Followers: unknown
- Themes: animal rescue video, breaking news
- Posts/day: unknown
- unknown (low)

New York Post

- Followers: unknown
- Themes: tabloid news
- Posts/day: unknown
- unknown (low)

Good News Movement

- Followers: FB unknown; Instagram 5.52M
- Themes: animals, community, no politics
- Posts/day: unknown
- brand deals (medium); FB pay (low)

Good News Network

- Followers: 607.5K (Feedspot, Jul)
- Themes: animals, rescues, science
- Posts/day: unknown
- site ads, membership (high for site)

Sunny Skyz

- Followers: 288.8K (Feedspot, Jul)
- Themes: kindness, animal rescue
- Posts/day: unknown
- own site (low); weak

c. Top Reels

No new competitor Reel with a public link and numbers was found today (4th day for motivation). Still-standing news examples from NewsWhip 2025:

CBS News: bear family raids a truck

- 1.2M+ engagements; views unknown
- Hook: wild animals doing something human, filmed by a bystander
- Footage: raw phone video, no graphics

https://www.facebook.com/CBSNews/videos/1347943573567942/

ABC News: two men free a monkey from a river

- 884K engagements; views unknown
- Hook: rescue in progress from second one
- Footage: eyewitness video

https://www.facebook.com/ABCNews/videos/1260994352228507/

Format notes without links (coach's client anecdotes, Lilach Bullock 2026):

- A 28-second Reel reached 380,000 views in nine days.
- A pet page went from under 2,000 views to 90,000 after sharpening the first line of text.
- Reels of 15 to 34 s finished more often than those over 45 s.

d. Our numbers yesterday

Page report run 38286023193, read 12:42 PM Chicago, Oct 12. Numbers only; no plan changes.

Unpopular Truths

- Followers: 7 (same).
- Oct 11: **0 Reels published**. Oct 12 by 12:42 PM: 0.
- Oct 10's 11 Reels now: 40 plays total (29 a day ago).
- Best of Oct 10: 'a perfect lazy day', 9 plays, 5.6 s watch.
- Worst: four hand-posted Reels, 1 play each.
- All-time best: 'hard days', 588 plays, 20 reactions, 3 shares.
- Reach: not available. Other posts: not readable (permission).

The 50 State Wire

- Followers: 1 (same).
- Oct 11: 10 Reels, **1,175 plays** in total.
- Best: hurricane deaths, 1,140 plays, 8 reactions, 3 shares, 4.3 s watch.

- Next: new press secretary 19 plays. All others 0 to 4.
- Worst: owl (South Dakota) and Six Flags, 0 plays each.
- Oct 12 so far: tornadoes (NC) 92 plays; eagle, Hurricane Simon, Opal Lee 0 each.
- Times are upload times (5:09 to 5:28 AM Chicago). No plan file, so real publish time may be later.
- Photo posts: not readable. 6 queued today, 1:00 to 8:30 PM.

https://www.facebook.com/reel/1451907776850414/

https://www.facebook.com/reel/1746925083276578/

e. New niches today

Wildlife and nature: 6.0

- Audience 8, engagement 7, ease 7, competition 4, money 4 (low confidence)
- Leaders: The Dodo 51.77M; National Wildlife Federation 1.2M; Defenders of Wildlife 770.5K
- Risk: fake AI animal videos are under scrutiny (Euronews, Jul 2026)
- Formula: one checked fact about a US animal, real licensed clip of that species, place on screen, calm music

Money lessons: 5.8

- Audience 7, engagement 6, ease 7, competition 4, money 5 (low confidence)
- Leaders: The Penny Hoarder 6.2M; Penny Pinchin Mom 981.7K; Good Financial Cents 676.7K
- Risk: trust; about half of US finance ads on Meta judged high-risk (BrokerChooser, 2026)
- Formula: one old-fashioned saving habit in our words, one public number (BLS, Fed), everyday footage, a question

DIY and home fixes: 5.2

- Audience 8, engagement 6, ease 4, competition 3, money 5 (low confidence)
- Leaders: Family Handyman 2.8M; Mr. Build It 760.9K; DIY Huntress 688.9K
- Risk: viewers want the real fix shown; fake hacks get exposed
- Formula: one seasonal home check from Energy Star or FEMA, text cards over a matching clip

Running top 5

1. Faith and prayer: 6.4
2. Cooking and old family recipes: 6.4
3. Gardening and homesteading: 6.2
4. Relationships and marriage advice: 6.0
5. True stories and history: 6.0

Ties broken by ease of automation, then engagement. Corrected today: Pets (ease 3) drops out. Just outside: wildlife 6.0.

f. What to upgrade on Unpopular Truths

1. Get Reels live every day again

- Evidence: 0 live on Oct 11 and by midday Oct 12, after 11 on Oct 10. Volume swings are a known risk (INMA).
- Test: Keep one steady number a day for 5 days.

2. Make Reels 15 to 34 seconds

- Evidence: Better completion in that band (Bullock, 2026). Our average watch is 1 to 6 s; under 5 s does not count for pay (Meta).
- Test: 20 s vs 30 s versions; compare average watch.

3. Line 1 on screen in the first frame

- Evidence: The first seconds decide; first-frame text and questions hold best (Bullock).
- Test: Half with line 1 at second 0; compare watch time.

4. Add one element only we have

- Evidence: Meta fingerprints videos and pushes down unoriginal ones (Apr 2026).
- Test: A fixed frame or our own short voice line on half the Reels.

5. Lead with 'hard days' and 'cares for everyone'

- Evidence: The only Reels with shares: 588 plays + 3 shares; 362 plays.
- Test: Already in the 5-day review.

6. Question as caption, 3 to 4 hashtags

- Evidence: Three hand-posted Reels went out with only one hashtag.
- Test: Keep as a rule.

7. Reply to every comment in the first hour

- Evidence: Comment quality weighs more in ranking (Fanpage Karma, 2026).
- Test: Log reply times once comments arrive.

Suggestions for The 50 State Wire

1. Open each batch with the biggest US weather or disaster story

- Evidence: 1,140 and 92 plays vs 0 to 19 for the other 12 Reels.
- Test: Tag story type for 5 days; compare median plays.

2. Number or place on screen in second one

- Evidence: Average watch 2.7 to 4.3 s; under 5 s does not count for pay.
- Test: Number-first card vs headline-first.

3. Spread uploads through the day

- Evidence: Each batch uploads within about 20 min; 11 of 14 Reels have 0 to 4 plays (our reading, not proven).
- Test: Stagger 2 hours apart for 3 days.

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Full tables and older sources:
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